Hindi heartland in a converted truck decorated to look like the chariot of an ancient Hindu warrior, making fiery speeches all the way. Hindu groups were exhorted to fire and consecrate bricks in every village in a Ram Shila Pujan (prayer ritual) and proceed with them to Ayodhya for use in the temple that would one day be built there. Pilgrimages were organised to Ayodhya to look at the spot where Hindus had to swallow the mortal insult of a holy site being occupied by a mosque. As emotions reached fever pitch, a howling, frenzied mob broke the 470-year old mosque apart in December 1992, levelling it to rubble while the police stood idly by.[58] The BJP had made its mark.

But while these two incidents tower above the others in the hall of infamy, the forces unleashed by Hindutva have led to numerous acts of violence in its name—and not only against non-Hindus. From the assassination of Mahatma Gandhi by Nathuram Godse in January 1948 for being too sympathetic to Muslims, to the murder of journalist Gauri Lankesh in September 2017 for her excoriating attacks on the Sangh Parivar, moderates, liberals and rationalists of Hindu background have also been targeted. It is distressing that there are BJP MPs who have publicly called for Gandhi's statues to be supplanted by those of Godse to commemorate his killing.

The catalogue of communal violence and riots, incited mainly by Hindutva organisations, is long and dismaying. Several erupted in 1964, 1965 and 1967, in places where Hindu refugees from the former East Pakistan were settled, notably Rourkela, Jamshedpur and Ranchi, where Hindu organisations exploited the refugees' tales of suffering to ignite communal passions and incite violence. The Bharatiya Jana Sangh's resolution on the 'Indianisation of Indian Muslims' played a role in the Ahmedabad riots in 1969 while the Shiv Sena's ('Army of Shiva', a Mumbai-based Hindu right wing organisation supported by Marathi-speakers) communal agenda helped spark those in Bhivandi-Jalgaon in 1970. The 1980s saw thousands of Muslims being killed in riots, starting with Moradabad in 1980 and carrying on through the horrors of Biharsharif, Meerut, Bhiwandi and Baroda to the massacre at Nellie in Assam and a slew of riots around the 'Ram Shila Pujan' agitations to consecrate bricks in towns across northern India to rebuild the Ram